

# SMALL WONDER

**Small enough to hide, powerful enough to be noticed**

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Imagine buying just the 'brain' of a computer, a sleek, aluminium block no bigger than a stack of coasters, only to realise that it is the real power player. For years, Apple's Mac mini was the quiet understudy of the desktop world, a budget-friendly option meant to be tucked away. Not anymore. With M6 silicon, the new Mac mini has moved from being Apple's neat desktop to a serious machine for AI, creative work and even gaming.

**Familiar Form Factor**

A compact 5 x 5-inch aluminium box, internal power supply and a footprint small enough to disappear behind a monitor. Ports are generous, with front USB-C, a headphone jack and rear Thunderbolt 4, HDMI and Ethernet. The power button underneath remains the design joke nobody asked for. An SD card slot would also please photographers and videographers.






**Small Size, Big Might**

M6 is Apple's first 2nm chip with a 12-core CPU, 12-core GPU and Dual 16-core Neural Engine. It feels effortlessly quick. Multitasking, editing, coding and creative apps barely make it blink. Local AI gets interesting, with Neural Accelerators bringing gains. For AI enthusiasts and people who want more flexibility, 24GB or 32GB is the machine to pick up. Gaming is another surprise. This is not a gaming PC, but titles are playable, impressive for something that looks like a coaster with ambition.

**What We Think?**

At ₹1,47,900 for 24GB RAM and 512GB storage in India, it is asking for a shiny penny. But its combination of size, performance and flexibility makes it compelling for power users who want the latest firepower in a compact form factor.